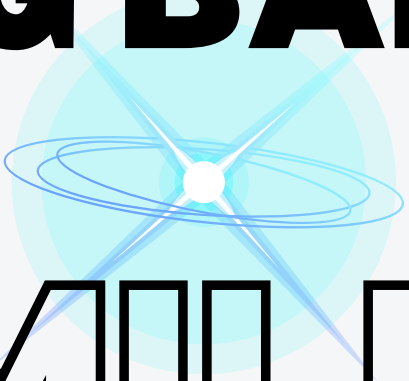


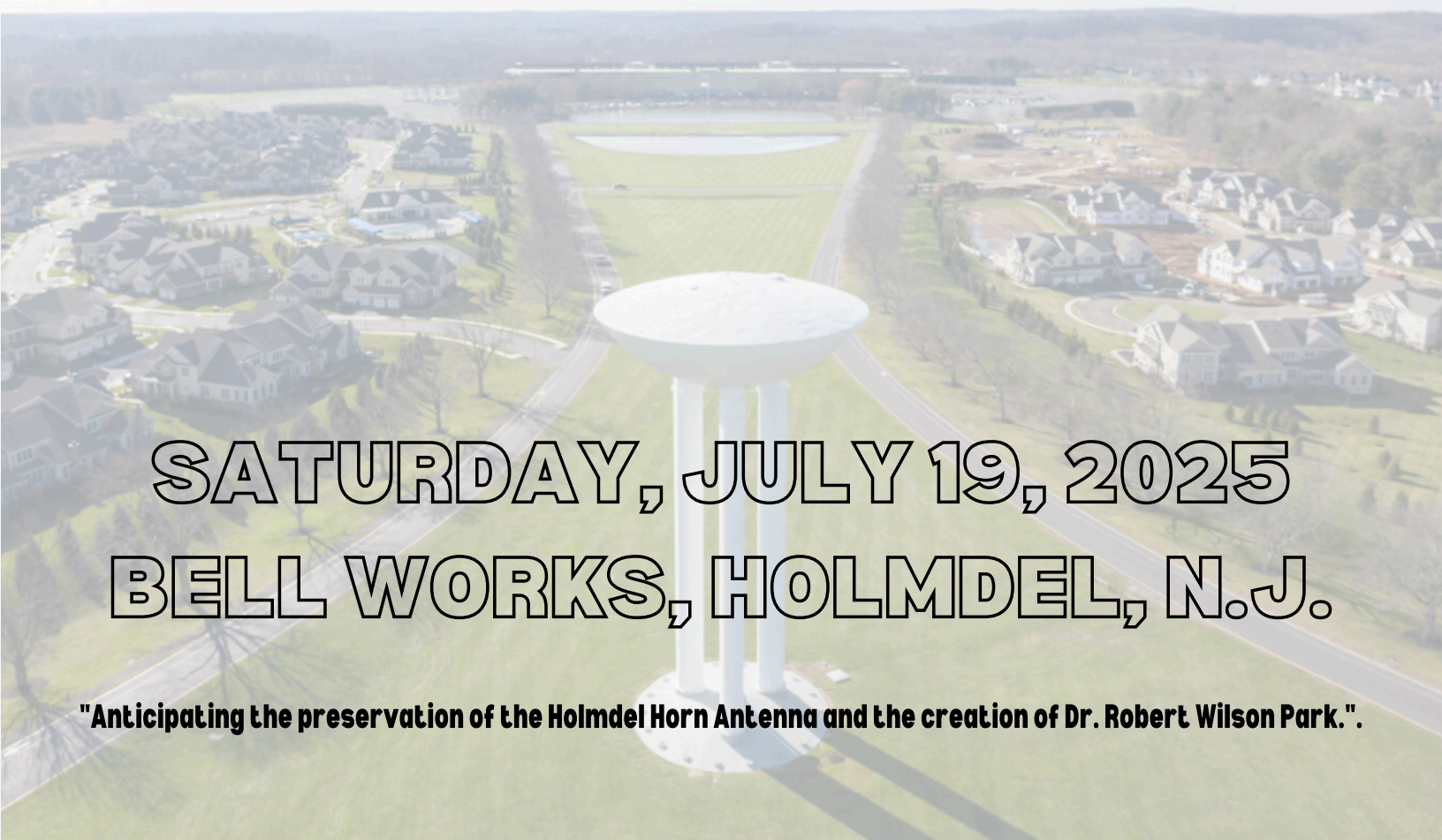
SHORE A.C.

BIG BANG



MILE

& SCIENCE FESTIVAL



SATURDAY, JULY 19, 2025

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SHORE ATHLETIC CLUB OF NEW JERSEY

"Promoting the Olympic Sport of Track and Field Since 1934"

WELCOME TO THE FIFTH ANNUAL BIG BANG MILE AND SCIENCE FESTIVAL

Shore Athletic Club is delighted to welcome you to its fifth annual Big Bang Mile and Science Festival. Please partake in our offering: a flat, fast mile course, professional timing, competitive heats, fun heats, great awards and the nearby amenities of Bell Works.

Why the name "Big Bang Mile"? We celebrate the discovery of the Big Bang not far from Bell Works. In 1964, two Bell Laboratories radio astronomers discovered more microwave radiation coming from the sky than they could at first explain. Consultation with Princeton University scientists led to the explanation: they were looking at leftover light (with highly red-shifted wavelengths) generated by the early universe 13.8 billion years ago!

To honor that discovery, Shore Athletic Club created a "mash-up." We combined a running race with a science festival. While the mile races are in others, runners and others can enjoy the booths on "Science Avenue".

Runners will be vying for some special prizes. The top three USATF-NJ masters male and female age grading winners overall will receive high-quality running shoes from Hylo Athletics. In the open category, the top male and female will win \$100 cash plus prizes worth close to \$400, while 2nd and 3rd places will earn \$100 and \$75 cash prizes. We will also be presenting special Big Bang Mile medals to winners in 5-year age groups.

We hope that you enjoy the Fifth Annual Big Bang Mile and Science Festival!

Shore AC Club President Erin O'Neill
P.O. Box 74
Belford, NJ 07718-9998

THE STORY BEHIND THE BIG BANG MILE



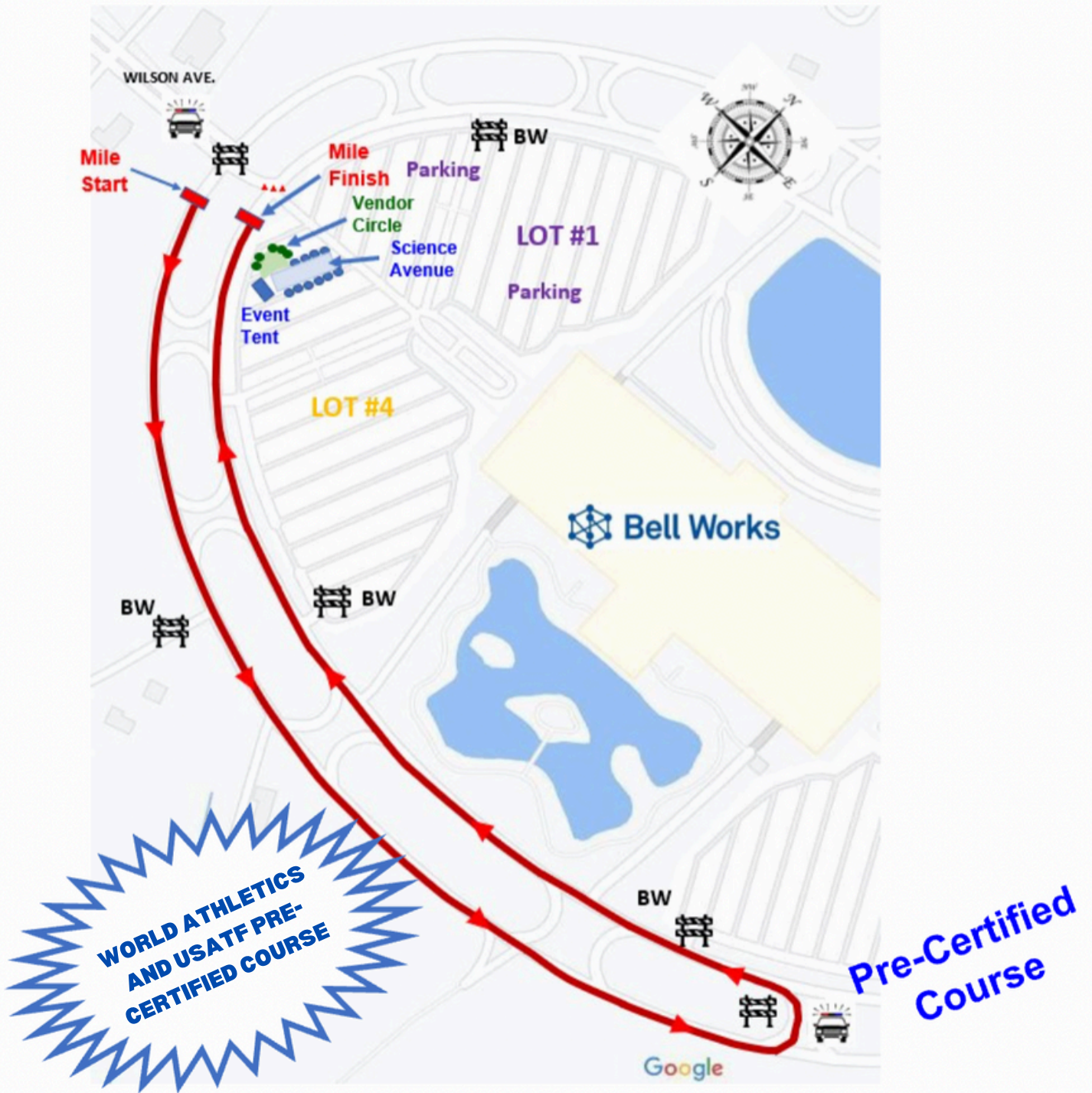
The Bell Works building was once a primary location for Bell Laboratories. “Bell Labs” attracted top-notch scientists to conduct basic research that might advance telephony. Two such scientists, Arno Penzias and Robert Wilson, studied radio signals from space in support of the Telstar project. In 1964, to their surprise, they observed a background noise coming from every direction in the sky. Wherever they pointed their radio telescope, they measured the same frequency and strength of microwave radiation.

Puzzled, Penzias and Wilson conferred with colleagues. Princeton University astronomer Robert Dicke revealed they had found evidence for the Big Bang. This is a theory that the universe started with an explosion 13.8 billion years ago. For their important contribution to science, Penzias and Wilson were awarded the Nobel Prize for Physics in 1978.

The radio telescope used by Penzias and Wilson still stands today. It is located on top of Crawford Hill, about 2 miles northwest of the Bell Works facility. A nearby plaque explains its significance. It is worth a visit.

Shore Athletic Club dedicates the Big Bang Mile Race to scientists everywhere. We hope that runners draw inspiration from this story to learn more about STEM(Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) and perhaps even pursue a STEM career. Aim high!

THE BIG BANG MILE COURSE MAP



SCHEDULE OF EVENTS: THE BIG BANG MILE

7:00 AM - Race Packet Pickup Opens

8:15 AM - Community & Youth Mile

8:40 AM -  John Saarmann Master's Men ages 60+ Mile

9:00 AM -  Hylo Athletics Masters Women's ages 50+ Mile

9:20 AM -  Masters Men's ages 50-59 Mile

9:35 AM -  Masters Women ages 40-49 Mile

9:50 AM -  Masters Men ages 40-49 Mile

10:05 AM - Coach Tim McLoone High & Middle School (12-18) Mile

10:20 AM - Fitness Team Mile

10:40 AM - Women's Open Mile

10:55 AM - Men's Open Mile

 *Designates a USATF-NJ Team Championship "race within a race." Non-USATF runners may also participate in these heats

- HS/MS heat name is courtesy of a donation from Susan and Scott Linnell.

Awards Ceremonies:

11:05 AM - Raffle for the first set of prizes

11:15 AM - Awards for High and Middle School Mile

11:30 AM - Awards for Fitness Team Mile

- Awards for Masters Women and Masters Men

11:50 AM - Awards for Open Women and Open Men

12:00 PM - Final raffle prize awarded

Major Multi-Year Sponsors

The Shore Athletic Club gratefully acknowledges the tremendously generous sponsorships that it has received from Mr. John Saarmann and Mr. Rakesh Antala for the Big Bang Mile and Science Festival during the past several years.

Mr. John Saarmann

The Shore Athletic Club gratefully acknowledges the tremendously generous sponsorships that it has received from Mr. John Saarmann for the Big Bang Mile and Science Festival during the past three years.

Born December 5, 1942, in Narva, Estonia, John and his family fled Estonia in 1944 as the Soviet Army advanced. They eventually reached a Displaced Persons (DP) camp in American-controlled Geislingen, Germany. In 1950, his family was able to secure a church sponsor in Oklahoma City. They came to America by ship and spent three years in Oklahoma City before moving to Hempstead, Long Island.



After graduating from high school in 1961, John enrolled in Stonybrook College. He graduated from there in 1965 with a BS degree in Physics and Math. John then obtained a Masters in Physics and Math from Hofstra University in 1968.

John entered the working world as a civilian electrical engineer at Picatinny Arsenal in New Jersey. His career at Picatinny spanned 50 years: 38 full-time and 12 part-time. He met his wife Mary there. They married in 1970 and settled in Stanhope, NJ. John has one son, Ian, and three grandsons. They all now reside on Cape Cod.

John joined the Shore Athletic Club in the 1970s at the urging of fellow Estonian John Kuhi. He raced many track events and XC races for Shore AC. His favorite track event was the 800.

Dr. Rakesh Antala

An area entrepreneur has played a pivotal role in the preservation of the Holmdel Horn Antenna atop Crawford Hill. Mr Rakesh Antala purchased the 43-acre Crawford Hill property from Nokia Bell Labs in 2020. He then sold 35 of those acres to Holmdel Township in 2023. This tract of land includes the Holmdel Horn Antenna. The Township in turn announced plans to convert the property into Dr. Robert Wilson Park.



Rakesh sponsored the 2024 Big Bang Mile by covering the cost of the age group and team medals. He repeated this generous gift this year. A picture of the medal appears nearby.



THE BIG BANG MILE CURRENT COURSE RECORDS

Category	Name	Age	Hometown	Time	Year
Men:	Brian Hill	23	Middletown, NJ	4:20.25	2023
Women:	Clara Peterson	39	Larkspur, CA	5:02.08	2023
Men:					
11U	Troy Kessler	10	Kenliworth, NJ	6:19.93	2023
12-14	Richard Riopel	14	Morganville, NJ	5:11.34	2023
15-17	Henry Bird	15	Monmouth Beach, NJ	4:43.51	2024
18-29	Brian Hill	23	Middletown, NJ	4:20.25	2023
30-34	Tim O'hearn	30	New York, NY	4:31.44	2024
35-39	Nicholas Musemuci	36	Island Heights, NJ	4:47.03	2023
40-44	Michael Dixon	40	Highland Park, NJ	4:43.04	2023
45-49	Edward Ross	49	Mullica Hills, NJ	4:55.23	2024
50-54	Mark Williams	50	Columbia, NJ	4:48.80	2023
55-59	Brian Crowley	58	Hillsborough, NJ	5:12.10	2023
60-64	Henry Notaro	61	Northfield, NJ	5:13.22	2023
65-69	Carl Gensib	65	Princeton, NJ	6:10.34	2024
70-74	James Linn	70	Harleysville, PA	6:00.38	2023
75-79	Ezequiel Garcia	77	Newark, NJ	7:01.82	2023
80-84	Robert O'Rourke	81	Jackson, NJ	8:12.65	2024
85+	Roland Ratmeyer	85	Bayonne, NJ	10:01.16	2023
Women:					
11U	Chessa Thieme	11	Manasquan, NJ	6:39.37	2024
12-14	Brielle MacDonald	12	Toms River, NJ	5:48.47	2024
15-17	Sadie Honig	17	Englishtown, NJ	5:38.79	2024
18-29	Summer Hill-Jones	28	Liverpool, PA	5:05.68	2023
30-34	Michelle Navarro	32	Red Bank, NJ	5:24.12	2023
35-39	Clara Peterson	39	Larkspur, CA	5:02.08	2023
40-44	Courtney Decker	41	Avon By The Sea, NJ	5:11.96	2023
45-49	Roberta Groner	45	Ledgewood, NJ	5:07.82	2023
50-54	Perry Shoemaker	52	Vienna, VA	5:19.83	2023
55-59	Jennifer Harvey	55	New York, NY	5:25.77	2023
60-64	Suzanne La Burt	61	Greenwood Lake, NY	5:55.82	2024
65-69	Diane Rothman	65	Leonardo, NJ	6:41.14	2023
70-74	Joann Coffee	74	Somerset, NJ	8:26.00	2023
75-79					
80-84					
85+					

THE BIG BANG MILE EVENT RECORDS

Category	Name	Age	Hometown	Time	Year
Men:	John Walker	24	Conshohocken, PA	4:13:50	2022
Women:	Clara Peterson	39	Larkspur, CA	5:02.08	2023
Men:					
11U	Declan Avestro	11	Freehold, NJ	6:04.60	2022
12-14	Gavin Schmitt	13	Holmdel, NJ	5:09.34	2022
15-17	Henry Bird	15	Monmouth Beach, NJ	4:43.51	2024
18-29	John Walker	24	Conshohocken, PA	4:13:50	2022
30-34	Tayron Reyes	31	Union City, NJ	4:22.91	2021
35-39	Hayrol Alvares	35	Passaic, NJ	4:26.36	2021
40-44	Michael Dixon	40	Highland Park, NJ	4:43.04	2023
45-49	Mark Williams	48	Columbia, NJ	4:42.50	2021
50-54	Mark Williams	50	Columbia, NJ	4:48.80	2023
55-59	Brian Crowley	56	Hillsborough, NJ	4:58.97	2021
60-64	Nat Larson	60	Amherst, MA	4:48.97	2022 *
65-69	Kevin Dollard	65	Hopewell Junction, NY	5:49.40	2021
70-74	James Linn	70	Harleysville, PA	6:00.38	2023
75-79	Ezequiel Garcia	75	Newark, NJ	6:49.53	2021
80-84	Robert O'Rourke	81	Jackson, NJ	8:12.65	2024
85+	Roland Ratmeyer	85	Bayonne, NJ	10:01.16	2023

* Ratified American Age Group Record

Women:					
11U	Chessa Thieme	11	Manasquan, NJ	6:39.37	2024
12-14	Liliah Gordon	14	Chesterfield, NJ	5:39.95	2021
15-17	Sadie Honig	17	Englishtown, NJ	5:38.79	2024
18-29	Summer Hill-Jones	28	Liverpool, PA	5:05.68	2023
30-34	Danielle Barnes	33	West Olive, MI	5:06.44	2022
35-39	Clara Peterson	39	Larkspur, CA	5:02.08	2023
40-44	Courtney Decker	40	Avon By The Sea, NJ	5:10.16	2022
45-49	Roberta Groner	45	Ledgewood, NJ	5:07.82	2023
50-54	Perry Shoemaker	52	Vienna, VA	5:19.83	2023
55-59	Jennifer Harvey	55	New York, NY	5:25.77	2023
60-64	Suzanne La Burt	61	Greenwood Lake, NY	5:55.82	2024
65-69	Nora Cary	67	Morristown, NJ	6:38.05	2022
70-74	Joann Coffee	70	Somerset, NJ	7:40.75	2021
75-79	Panseluta Geer	75	Hazlet, NJ	12:31.17	2022
80-84					
85+					

2025 BIG BANG MILE & SCIENCE FESTIVAL EVENT MAP



SCIENCE FESTIVAL BOOTHS

#1 - TBD

- **TO BE DETERMINED**
- PRESENTED BY:

#2 - ELECTRONICS

- **INTEGRATED CIRCUIT MANUFACTURING**
- PRESENTED BY: MR. ERIC WESTERWICK

#3 - ASTRONOMY

- **BACKYARD STARGAZING**
- PRESENTED BY: S*T*A*R ASTRONOMY

#4 - COMMUNICATIONS

- **20TH CENTURY COMMUNICATIONS**
- PRESENTED BY: INFOAGE SCIENC AND HISTORY MUSEUMS

#5 - ELECTRIC VEHICLES

- **EV TECHNOLOGY**
- PRESENTED BY: LUCID MOTORS

#6 - TBD

- **TO BE DETERMINED**
- PRESENTED BY:

#7 - PROFESSIONALISM

- **PROFESSIONAL SOCIETIES**
- PRESENTED BY: IEEE & ETA KAPPA NU

#8 - ZOOLOGY

- **KIM'S CRITTERS**
- PRESENTED BY: MS. KIM ANICITO

#9 - HEALTH

- **SCOUTING**
- SCOUTING AMERICA MONMOUTH COUNCIL

#10 - HEALTH

- **SCOUTING**
- SCOUTING AMERICA MONMOUTH COUNCIL

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SCIENCE TALKS

This year, the Science Talks occurred prior to the Big Bang Mile and Science Festival. The Science Talks were held on Sunday, July 13th, 2025 at Bell Works in Holmdel.

Recordings exist at https://www.youtube.com/live/3xdQT_a42MY?si=t1EwJi8S7G46RsGY (talk #1) and <https://www.youtube.com/live/xx9b5bLLYS0?si=MP5ujdYATclqVZBA> (talk #2).

9:15 AM

Presentation on Cosmology: From Dark Ages to Dark Energy: A Fascinating History of Cosmology.

Presented by Dr. Sarbmeet Kanwal, Professor of Physics & Astronomy, Brookdale Community College

Dr. Sarbmeet Kanwal



Sarbmeet Kanwal is a professor of physics at Brookdale Community College where he has been recognized for his teaching innovations. He received a PhD in Theoretical Particle Physics from the California Institute of Technology, after which he worked for many years in wireless telecommunications research at Bell Labs. Sarbmeet is also an instructor for Deeptime Network, an organization which has a mission of orienting humanity to an evolving interconnected universe as a context within which to visualize a prosperous and peaceful future. As a member of New Jersey's Monmouth Center for World Religions and

Ethical Thought, he founded an interfaith youth leadership program called MOSAIC (Mobilizing Our Students for Action to build Interfaith Community), and was awarded the Earl Thomas Teasley Humanitarian Award for this work in promoting peace building within the community. Sarbmeet is a sought-after speaker on topics that range from cosmology to spirituality, and the author of two TEDx talks: [Chaos to Cosmos](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HW_PLtH2uDg&t=4s)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HW_PLtH2uDg&t=4s, and [Science Reimagined: Harmony Through Awe](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QYmluD415s4)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QYmluD415s4>.

10:30 AM

Presentation on nuclear fusion energy: "The Fastest Route to Fusion Energy".

Presented by: Eric J. Lerner Chief Scientist LPPFusion, Inc.

Eric J. Lerner



Eric Lerner has been active in fusion research for 45 years. Beginning in 1984, he developed a detailed quantitative theory of the functioning of the dense plasma focus device (DPF). Based on this theory, he proposed that the DPF could achieve high ion and electron energies at high densities, suitable for hydrogen-boron fusion and space propulsion. First with funding from NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory, and then with investor funding for LPPFusion, Inc. he and a small team achieved record high temperatures, 100 times that of the center of the sun. He is also a leader in developing an alternative to the Big Bang theory and is the author of the 1991 book, [The Big Bang Never Happened](#). In both fusion and cosmology his work has been published in leading peer-reviewed journals.

A STAR PARK IS BORN: HOLMDEL BUYS HORN ANTENNA LAND

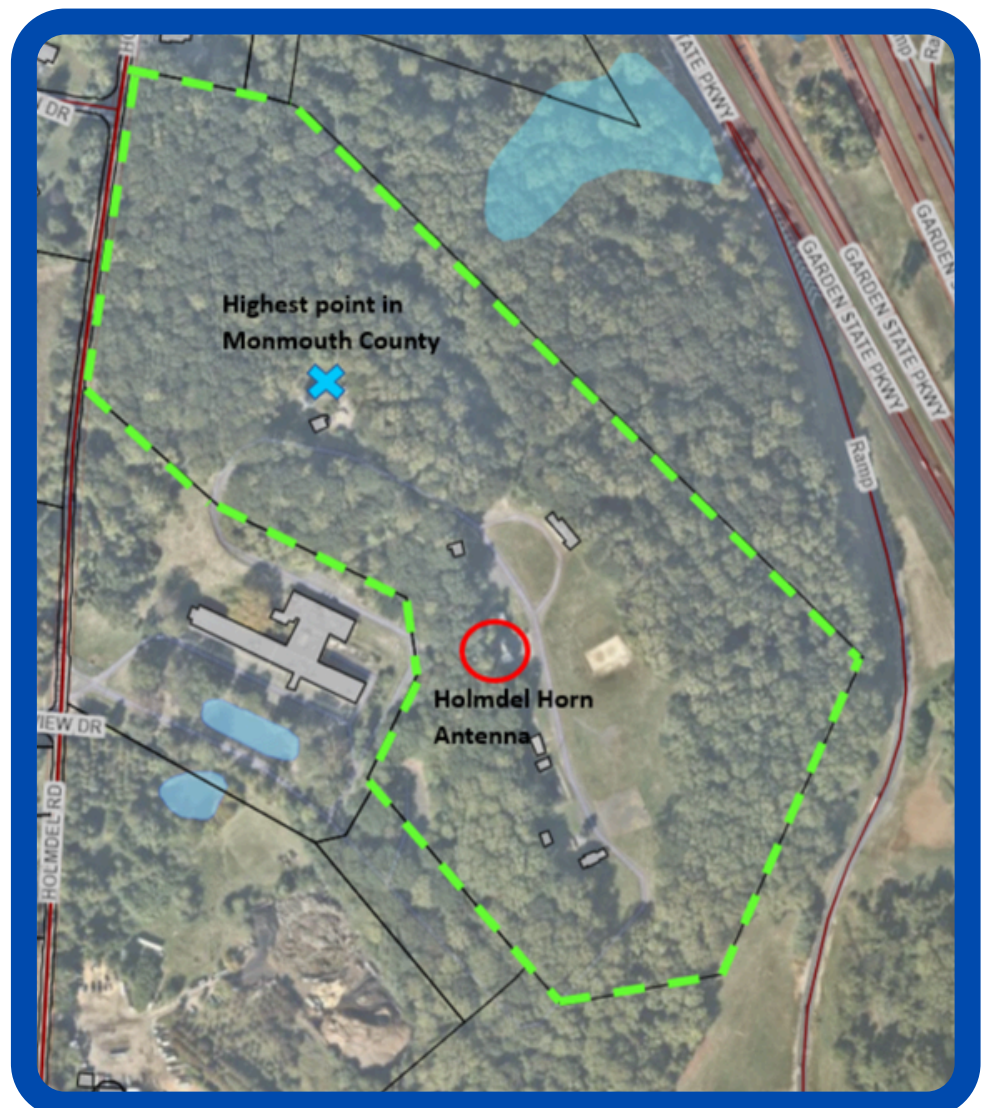
It was a dream come true for the thousands of people who advocated for preservation of the Holmdel Horn Antenna. On January 23 of 2024, Holmdel Township completed the purchase of most of the former Bell Laboratories property on which the famous Horn Antenna sits.

Shortly thereafter, the Township announced that the property would become Dr. Robert Wilson Park in honor of Holmdel's famous resident. Holmdel Township held a special ribbon-cutting ceremony on April 20 to formally announce the future park. Park planning is now underway in earnest.

The map below indicates the outline of the new park.

.....
**Dr. Robert Wilson
Park Boundaries**
.....

**Home of the Holmdel
Horn Antenna**
.....



SHORE AC UPCOMING EVENTS

Lake Takanassee Summer Series - 6:00pm Reg, 6:45pm race

Monday Nights - July 21th, 28th and August 4th, 2025

Lake Takanassee, 800 Ocean Avenue, Long Branch, NJ

Kids 1500m run, Adult 5k run



Asbury Park Sheehan Classic - 8:00am race

Saturday, August 9th, 2025

Bradley Park, Asbury Park, NJ

Adult 5k run, kiddie dashes



Lester Wright Jr. Youth Cross Country Fall Series - 9:00am

Sundays, September 21st, 27th, October 12th, 19th, 26th, 2025

Holmdel Park

800m, 2k, 3k, 4k, and 5k



Adult Cross Country Series - 9:00am

Saturdays, October 4th, 11th, 18th, 25th and November 1st, 8th, 2025

Various Monmouth County Parks

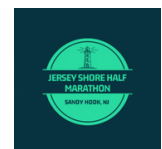
5k



Jersey Shore Half Marathon + 2 Mile Race - 9:00am

Sunday, October 5th, 2025

Gateway National Recreation Area, Sandy Hook, NJ



Bill Bruno Alumni Cross Country Run - 8:30am 5k, 9:00am 3k

Saturday, November 15th, 2025

Holmdel Park, 44 Longstreet Road, Holmdel, NJ 07733

3k and 5k



62nd Annual Asbury Park Polar Bear Races - 10:00am

Saturday, December 27th, 2025

Convention Hall - 1300 Ocean Avenue Asbury Park, NJ 07712

1 mile, 5k run & walk



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Wednesday 9am - 3pm

Thursday 10am - 7pm

Friday 9am - 6pm

Saturday Temporarily Closed

Closed on Sunday

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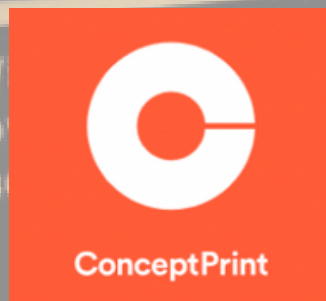
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